Unified University Inventory System (UUIS)

So basically right now we've got no single way of tracking everything the university owns across the faculties — computers, furniture, software licenses, rooms, even who's sitting where — and it's all over the place depending on which department you ask. Each faculty kind of does its own thing with spreadsheets or whatever old system they inherited, and nobody at the university level can just look something up and trust the answer. We want to build one system that everybody logs into, students, staff, IT people, deans, whoever, and depending on who they are they can see and manage the stuff that's relevant to them, but it's all sitting in one place instead of scattered everywhere.

The way I picture it, once someone logs in (and for the people with more access we probably want something extra like a voice check, not just a password) they land on a menu where they can look up people, assets, locations and licenses, add new ones, edit them, get rid of stuff that's no longer around. Nothing should ever really disappear though, more like get marked as inactive so we keep history. People should also be able to lump assets or rooms into groups, like all the printers on a floor, or split things into subgroups, and bring in old data from CSV files from whatever system they're using today instead of typing everything from scratch.

There's also this whole request and approval thing that matters a lot to us. If someone wants to move an item, report something broken, or just ask for a new asset, they should be able to submit that and it goes up to whoever's one level above them to approve or deny it, and if they say no they need to actually explain why. The exception is the people at the very top, university-level admins basically, their requests just go through automatically since there's nobody above to check them. Speaking of levels, this is kind of the backbone of the whole thing: department, faculty, university, and then a base user level, and what you can see and touch depends on where you sit, a faculty admin can reach into all the departments under them but a department admin only sees their own patch.

We also want decent search, both a quick one where you just type something and a more detailed one where you can filter by different fields and combine conditions, plus some basic reporting, like comparing how many chairs or computers a room has against its supposed capacity. And everything anyone does in the system needs to get logged somewhere so if there's ever a question about who changed what, someone with the right permission can pull that up.

A couple more things that matter even if they're not the flashy part. We can't have more than about two hundred people hammering the system at the same time, so it needs to hold up under that kind of load without falling over. If nobody touches it for half an hour, just log them out automatically, we don't want sessions sitting open forever. And if something crashes or a connection drops halfway through someone entering data, whatever they hadn't saved yet needs to come back to them when they log back in instead of just vanishing, losing someone's work because the system hiccuped would be a nightmare. On the security side, everything going over the network needs to be encrypted properly, and let's put a CAPTCHA on anything automated so bots can't just hammer the login.

Things like managing permissions themselves, creating new roles, tweaking what each role can do, that's more of an admin-only corner of the system and honestly not the part we're most excited about, it just needs to exist so the higher-ups can keep control. Multiple languages and that kind of polish, plus the heavier department and faculty specific functions, those can wait for a later version, we're fine if version one is English-only and covers the main stuff for now. What we really care about for this first round is getting people, assets, locations and licenses all visible and manageable in one web system that anyone in the university can log into through a browser without needing anything special installed.